

■ Halo Effect

■ What is it?

Positive impressions in one area influence how people judge the rest of a product, person, or brand. One good feature can make everything else feel good.

■ History

Introduced by Edward Thorndike in 1920. Later research proved the brain prefers fast first-impression based judgment to avoid mental conflict and reduce effort.

■ The Psychology Behind It

- Brain avoids conflicting info - One positive trait biases the entire perception - Negative version exists (Horn Effect) - We want our first belief to stay consistent

■ Why It Matters

- Unrealistic expectations - Overlooking flaws - Unfair comparisons - Positive bias spreads fast

■ How to Apply It

- Craft strong first impressions - Keep brand claims realistic - Encourage unbiased reviews
- Maintain consistent quality across journey

■ Theory in Action

- Apple: premium feel spreads across all products - Disney: theme park experience shapes movie + merchandise reputation

■ Final Thought

Halo Effect influences fast snap judgement. But if your product doesn't continually deliver, the effect fades.